



World War ships

Turret contained three 15 in (38 cm) guns

778 ft (237 m) long

Rear gun turret packs three 18 in (46 cm) guns

The **Yamato's** giant guns could fire shells at targets **26 miles** (42 km) away.

Gunnery spotting position high above deck

First battleship to run on steam turbine engines

HMS Dreadnought UK 1906

535 ft (163 m) long

Gun turret protected by 10½-in (27.5-cm) thick armor at the front

Deck armor up to 9½ in (25 cm) thick in places

Three funnels released gases from the ship's 12 boilers

Spar fitted to mast to raise signal flags that send messages to other ships in the fleet

P34 patrol boat UK 1916

Lifeboats for crew of 50 to 55

Oversized rudder to help the vessel turn sharply

Tank deck could hold up to nine 33-ton tanks

Bow ramp opens to let tanks roll off

SMS Regensburg Germany 1915

466 ft (142 m) long

Turret carried two 15 in (38 cm) artillery guns

Single low funnel

Radar used to control and direct guns when aiming at targets

Twin rudders

Bismarck Germany 1940

807 ft (246 m) long

Shipping played a crucial part in both World War I and World War II. As well as fighting in battles, warships were used to disrupt enemy supply convoys, protect their own navies, and transport troops and equipment to invade enemy territory.

HMS Dreadnought was faster and more heavily armed than previous battleships and started an arms race between the major naval powers before World War I. Smaller ships, such as the cruiser **SMS Regensburg**, and the **P34 patrol boat**, saw active service during WWI. P34 was